

Critical Review of The Future of Globalization by Uri Dadush

Introduction

In *The Future of Globalization*, Uri Dadush (2017) argues that despite the rise of nationalism, protectionism, and political uncertainty, globalization is not ending. Instead, he believes that globalization will continue because it is driven by strong economic forces, technological innovation, and international cooperation. The paper discusses the causes of recent resistance to globalization while also explaining why global integration is likely to persist. This review summarizes the main arguments of the paper, critically evaluates its strengths and weaknesses, and presents my own perspective supported by real-world examples and academic evidence. In my opinion, globalization has changed significantly over the past decade, but it has not disappeared. I believe understanding both its opportunities and challenges is essential for evaluating its future.

Summary

Dadush begins by explaining how globalization has expanded rapidly since the end of the Cold War. International trade, foreign direct investment, migration, tourism, and digital communication have all grown significantly. He highlights the increasing role of developing countries, particularly China and India, in driving global economic growth and international trade.

The author argues that although world trade slowed after the 2008 global financial crisis, this does not mean globalization has reached its end. According to him, the slowdown was mainly caused by temporary economic conditions rather than a permanent structural change. He also emphasizes that digital globalization, including e-commerce and cross-border data flows, continues to strengthen global integration.

Another major argument is that globalization is sustained by three powerful forces: markets, technology, and governments. While governments sometimes introduce protectionist policies, market demand and technological progress eventually encourage countries to reconnect with the global economy.

Dadush also recognizes the negative consequences of globalization. He explains that many low-skilled workers in developed countries have experienced wage stagnation and job losses due to international competition and automation. These

economic pressures have contributed to the rise of nationalism, Brexit, and protectionist policies in countries such as the United States and parts of Europe. Nevertheless, the author concludes that globalization will continue if governments combine open markets with stronger social protection and investment in education and healthcare.

Critical Analysis

One of the strongest aspects of this paper is its balanced approach. Rather than presenting globalization as either completely beneficial or completely harmful, Dadush acknowledges both its achievements and its challenges. This balanced discussion makes the paper more convincing because it recognizes the concerns of workers while still defending the long-term benefits of global integration. I personally appreciate this balanced perspective because many discussions about globalization focus only on either its benefits or its disadvantages, while this paper considers both sides.

Another important strength is the extensive use of reliable evidence. The paper draws information from organizations such as the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the United Nations, and the McKinsey Global Institute. These sources increase the credibility of the author's arguments and demonstrate careful research. In my opinion, using data from internationally recognized organizations makes the paper more trustworthy and strengthens the author's conclusions.

I also agree with Dadush's argument that technology has become one of the main drivers of globalization. Today, businesses can sell products through digital platforms without establishing physical stores in foreign countries. Companies such as Amazon, Alibaba, and Shopify demonstrate that digital trade has transformed international business. From my perspective, social media platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok have also helped small businesses reach international customers, making globalization more accessible than ever before.

However, the paper also has several limitations. First, although it discusses economic inequality, it pays relatively little attention to environmental sustainability. Modern globalization has increased international production and transportation, contributing to higher carbon emissions and climate change. I believe environmental sustainability should receive greater attention because

economic development cannot be considered successful if it causes long-term environmental damage.

Second, the paper was published in 2017, before several major global events that have reshaped international trade. For example, the COVID-19 pandemic exposed weaknesses in global supply chains as countries experienced shortages of medical equipment, semiconductors, and other essential products. Similarly, increasing geopolitical tensions, including the US-China trade dispute, have encouraged many firms to diversify production or relocate manufacturing closer to home. In my opinion, these events show that globalization is becoming more flexible and resilient rather than disappearing completely.

From my perspective, globalization is becoming more regional and digital instead of disappearing. Countries continue to trade internationally, but they are also seeking greater resilience by reducing dependence on a single supplier or market. Therefore, I partly agree with Dadush's conclusion that globalization will persist, but I believe its future will be characterized by diversification, technological innovation, and stronger regional partnerships.

The author's arguments are also relevant to developing countries such as Bangladesh. Bangladesh's ready-made garment industry depends heavily on international markets for exports, creating millions of jobs and contributing significantly to economic growth. At the same time, the country remains vulnerable to changes in global demand and international trade policies. As a student from Bangladesh, I believe globalization has created employment opportunities and improved economic growth, but it has also increased dependence on foreign markets. Therefore, Bangladesh should diversify its export sectors while continuing to participate actively in global trade.

Overall, Dadush successfully achieves his objective of explaining why globalization is likely to survive despite increasing political resistance. His arguments are logical, supported by credible evidence, and presented in a clear structure. Although the paper would benefit from greater discussion of environmental issues and more recent global developments, its central message remains highly relevant.

Conclusion

The Future of Globalization is a well-researched and persuasive policy paper that provides valuable insights into the future of global economic integration. The author effectively explains the historical development of globalization, the reasons for current protectionist movements, and the forces that will likely sustain globalization in the future. While some evidence has become dated due to recent global events, the overall analysis remains convincing. In my opinion, globalization will continue to evolve rather than disappear. Digital technology, innovation, and international cooperation will remain the key drivers of global integration, while governments must ensure that the benefits of globalization are distributed more fairly among different groups of society. For these reasons, this paper is an important contribution to understanding globalization and its future direction.

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